Washington State Department of Labor & Industries

Subscribe to updates from Washington State Labor & Industries

Email Address e.g. name@exa

Subscribe

Share Bulletin

L&I News: Businesses ignoring pandemic closure orders can be cited and fined under emergency rules filed today

Washington State Department of Labor & Industries sent this bulletin at 05/26/2020 02:42 PM PDT

Having trouble viewing this email? View it as a Web page.

Washington State Department of Labor & Industries | NEWS Communication Services
360-902-5400 ■ www.News.Lni.wa.gov

Businesses ignoring pandemic closure orders can be cited and fined under emergency rules filed today

May 26, 2020 #20-014

TUMWATER — Washington businesses that decide to open or operate in direct violation of Gov. Inslee's Stay Home, Stay Healthy order may be cited and fined for unsafe workplace conditions under emergency rules filed today by the state Department of Labor & Industries.

The closure order and the Safe Start Plan to reopen businesses are in place to keep workers and the public safe and to prevent the spread of the easily transmissible coronavirus.

The emergency rules, enacted at the direction of the Governor, take effect immediately. They give the Department of Labor & Industries (L&I) the authority to cite businesses for being open or for operating in a way that is purposely defying the phased-in approach and, as a result, putting their workers at risk.

"We're all in this together, and most businesses are doing the right thing for our state and our communities. Unfortunately, there are some that are choosing not to," said L&I Director Joel Sacks. "The coronavirus is a known workplace hazard and businesses must follow the requirements to keep their workers and the public safe."

Protecting worker safety and ensuring a level playing field

L&I will work with the state Emergency Operations Center to take in and respond to complaints about businesses that are operating illegally. If employers are found to be defying the Governor's order, they'll be informed and directed to close or adjust operations immediately. If they do not, they'll face a workplace safety citation that could carry a fine of nearly $10,000 or more.

Along with contacting businesses by phone and in writing, L&I will perform in-person spot checks on some of the businesses to make sure they are following through and complying with the Safe Start requirements. It's not fair to employers who are following the law when other businesses defy it. L&I's role will complement efforts by the Liquor and Cannabis Board and other state licensing and permitting agencies.

Stay informed

The nature of the outbreak changes daily so it's important for everyone to have the most current information. L&I has a COVID-19 webpage, and there's important information on the state Coronavirus Response (COVID-19) site. There's also an online form for people to report suspected violations of the Governor's orders regarding essential business functions, evictions, and social distancing.

Information is the best resource to protect workers and the public. L&I urges employers to stay as informed as possible, and to take all measures necessary to keep Washington workers safe and healthy.

###

For media information: Tim Church, **L&I** Director of Communication**s, 360-972-4876.**

Connect with L&I: Facebook (facebook.com/laborandindustries) and Twitter (twitter.com/lniwa).

© Washington State Department of Labor & Industries.

Webmaster@Lni.wa.gov

Access Agreement | Privacy & Security Statement | Intended Use/External Content Policy

Subscribe/unsubscribe or modify your account settings. You will need your email address to log in. If you have questions or problems with the subscription service, please visit subscriberhelp.govdelivery.com.

Powered by GOVDELIVERY

Privacy Policy | Cookie Statement | Help